POLI101: Introduction to Global Politics

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Office Hours: T 2:00-4:00 PM (via Zoom) or by appointment
Web: bje1012.github.io/
Class Hours: Web Asynchronous

Course Description

This course introduces students to a wide range of key topics in global politics, such as interstate disputes, civil conflict, human rights, international political economy, international organizations, and international law. Throughout the course, students are encouraged to develop critical thinking skills by identifying major actors in political events, understanding core concepts in the field, and building a solid foundation in the study of international relations. Emphasis is placed on connecting theoretical ideas to real-world developments, using current events to highlight recurring patterns and processes in global politics. Through engagement with current global issues, students will strengthen their understanding of present-day international affairs while developing the analytical skills necessary to evaluate and make sense of future challenges in a complex global environment.

Course Objectives

Upon completing this course, students will achieve the following learning outcomes:

1. **Understand fundamental concepts and ideas of global politics**
    - Students will deepen their understanding of key concepts and ideas related to global political dynamics, enhancing their knowledge of international affairs.
2. **Analyze political developments using core political science concepts**
    - Students will learn how to identify and analyze major political developments by applying basic political science concepts to real-world cases, fostering analytical thinking and problem-solving skills.
3. **Develop a foundation for upper-level courses in political science**
    - As an introductory class, this course provides the foundational knowledge and analytical skills necessary for success in upper-level political science courses.

Required Materials

Jeffry A. Frieden, David A. Lake, and Kenneth A. Schultz. *World Politics: Interests, Interactions, and Institutions*. W. W. Norton & Company.

- Class materials will draw on this textbook, which will serve primarily as a background and reference resource. Students are encouraged, but not required, to purchase the textbook.

- Course content will be delivered through weekly lecture videos. Because these videos are intended to provide the complete course instruction, lecture slides will not be posted separately. One lecture video will be released each week according to the course schedule. Students are expected to watch each lecture during the assigned week and stay on pace with the course schedule.

Course Structure

This course is offered fully online in an asynchronous format. While you have the flexibility to complete coursework on your own schedule, online courses are not easier than face-to-face classes. Success in this course requires self-motivation, effective time management, and consistent engagement with the course materials.

Course Formats

1. **Participation in Discussion** (20%)

   - Students are expected to actively participate in online discussions on Blackboard. Discussion prompts will be provided within the weekly lecture videos. Each discussion session is worth **4 points**, for a maximum participation score of **20 points**. Students may earn the full **4 points** by completing one of the following options:
     - Submit **one** original discussion post consisting of at least **6 sentences**.
     - Submit **two** replies to other students' posts. Each reply must consist of at least **3 sentences**, and the two replies must address different content or ideas. **Submitting only one reply will not receive credit.**
   - Students may choose which discussion sessions to participate in based on their own schedules and preferences. There are **7 discussion sessions** throughout the semester, but students are only required to complete **5 of them**.
   - Discussions will open every Monday. Original posts must be submitted by Friday at 11:59 PM, while replies must be submitted by Sunday at 11:59 PM.
   - Discussion Schedule:
     - Discussion Session 1: Opens 08/31, Post by 09/04, Replies by 09/06
     - Discussion Session 2: Opens 09/14, Post by 09/18, Replies by 09/20
     - Discussion Session 3: Opens 09/28, Post by 10/02, Replies by 10/04
     - Discussion Session 4: Opens 10/05, Post by 10/09, Replies by 10/11
     - Discussion Session 5: Opens 10/26, Post by 10/30, Replies by 11/01
     - Discussion Session 6: Opens 11/16, Post by 11/20, Replies by 11/22
     - Discussion Session 7: Opens 11/30, Post by 12/04, Replies by 12/06
   - Because students have the flexibility to choose when and how they participate throughout the semester, **no make-up opportunities will be provided for missed discussion activities.**

2. **Quizzes** ($10 \times 2\%$ each = 20%)

   - There will be **12 quizzes** throughout the semester, designed primarily to track students' weekly engagement and assess their understanding of basic concepts from the lectures. Each quiz will consist of two multiple-choice questions and will be worth **2 points**. **Only the highest 10 quiz scores will count toward the final grade, for a maximum of 20 points.** Quizzes will be conducted through Blackboard (See course schedule for the deadlines).

3. **Country Report** (20%)

   - Students will write a report of approximately 800–1,000 words on a country of their choosing. The report is due on **November 8 at 11:59 PM** and must be submitted as a PDF via Blackboard. Further instructions will be provided on Blackboard.

4. **Midterm/Final Exams** (2 × 20% each = 40%)
    - The midterm and final exams will consist of multiple-choice questions. Each exam is worth 20 points, for a total of 40 points. Exams will be conducted through Blackboard.
    - Since students will be given a 24 hour window (12:00 AM–11:59 PM) to take the exam, there will be no make-up exams, except for extreme cases.
    - Study guides will be posted on Blackboard prior to each exam.

Grading Scale

The following grading scale will be used to determine final letter grades.

A: 90-100 ; B+: 85-89 ; B: 80-84 ; C+: 75-79 ; C: 70-74 ; D+: 65-69 ; D: 60-64 ; F: 0-59

Important Dates

1. Midterm : **October 12**
2. Country Report: **November 8 at 11:59pm**
3. Final Exam: **December 7**

Course Policy

Course Communication

Important course announcements and information regarding assignments will be communicated through Blackboard. Email is the preferred method for contacting me, and I will generally respond within 24 hours. Please include "POLI 101" in the subject line when emailing me. Email: jbyeon@email.sc.edu

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) Policy

Students are permitted to use generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT) to support their learning and to explore how these tools can inform their understanding of the course topics. However, the use of generative AI is strictly prohibited when completing the country report, quizzes, exams, discussion posts, and discussion replies. All submitted work for these assignments must reflect the student's own original work. Unauthorized use of generative AI on any of these assignments may result in a grade of zero and will be handled in accordance with the University's academic integrity policies.

Academic Dishonesty Policy

I will enforce rigorous standards of academic integrity in all aspects of this course. For the detailed policy of the University of South Carolina regarding the definitions of acts considered to fall under academic dishonesty and possible ensuing sanctions, see the University Honor Code: Academic Responsibility – The Honor Code. If you have any questions about potentially improper research citations or references, or about any activity that may be interpreted as academic dishonesty, please see me before the assignment is due.

Accommodations

If you are a person with a disability and anticipate needing any type of accommodation in order to participate in this class, please advise me and make appropriate arrangements with the Student Disability Resource Center. All disability accommodations must be approved through the Student Disability Resource Center. For more information, see Student Disability Resource Center. Special accommodations are also available for veterans on duty and for parents.

Technical Support

If you have questions or problems related to your computer or software, or if you need technical support (including Blackboard support), please contact the Division of Information Technology (DoIT) Service Desk at (803) 777-1800, submit an online request through the Self-Service Portal or visit the Carolina Tech Zone. The Service Desk is open Monday – Friday from 8:00 AM – 6:00 PM (Eastern Time). You may also visit DoIT's website for available technology resources. If you have computer issues, there is a computer lab available at the Thomas Cooper Library and in certain campus classroom buildings.

Personal Integrity

I am committed to creating and fostering a positive learning and working environment based on open communication, mutual respect, and inclusion. I will not tolerate discrimination and harassment on the basis of identity or status, including race, color, national origin, religion, sex, gender, age, disability, sexual orientation, genetics, or veteran status. For more information on the University Student Non-Discrimination and Non-Harassment Policy, see Student Non-Discrimination and Non-Harassment Policy. If you wish to speak to someone about an incident involving harassment, sexual assault, or interpersonal violence, you may call 803-777-8248 to speak with a trained interpersonal violence advocate.

Additional Information

Students are responsible for knowing both university and course schedules. The academic calendar is available at: University Registrar.
For undergraduate academic regulations, see: Undergraduate Academic Regulations.

Course Schedule

The schedule is tentative and subject to change.

Week 01, 08/17 - 08/21: Course Introduction & Global Politics

- Chapter 1: What shaped our world? A historical introduction
- **Quiz 1** due Aug 23 at 11:59 PM

Week 02, 08/24 - 08/28: Interests, Interactions, and Institutions I

- Chapter 2: Understanding interests, interactions, and institutions
- **Quiz 2** due Aug 30 at 11:59 PM

Week 03, 08/31 - 09/04: Interests, Interactions, and Institutions II

- Chapter 2: Understanding interests, interactions, and institutions
- **Quiz 3** due Sep 6 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 1*

Week 04, 09/07 - 09/11: Interstate Conflict I

- Chapter 3: Why are there wars?
- **Quiz 4** due Sep 13 at 11:59 PM

Week 05, 09/14 - 09/18: Interstate Conflict II

- Powell, R., 2006. War as a commitment problem. *International organization*, 60(1), pp.169-203.
- Chapter 4: Domestic politics and war
- **Quiz 5** due Sep 20 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 2*

Week 06, 09/21 - 09/25: **Guest Lecture** – Alliances

- **Quiz 6** due Sep 27 at 11:59 PM

Week 07, 09/28 - 10/02: Intrastate Conflict I

- Chapter 6: Violence by nonstate actors: civil war and terrorism
- *Discussion Session 3*

Week 08, 10/05 - 10/09: Intrastate Conflict II & Review for Midterm

- Chapter 6: Violence by nonstate actors: civil war and terrorism
- Walter, B.F., 2009. Bargaining failures and civil war. *Annual review of political science*, 12(1), pp.243-261.
- **Quiz 7** due Oct 11 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 4*

Week 09, 10/12 - 10/16: Midterm (**Oct 12**)

Week 10, 10/19 - 10/23: International Political Economy I

- Chapter 7: International trade
- **Quiz 8** due Oct 25 at 11:59 PM

Week 11, 10/26 - 10/30: International Political Economy II

- Chapter 9: International monetary relations
- **Quiz 9** due Nov 1 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 5*

Week 12, 11/02 - 11/06: Development & Environment **(Country Report Due Nov 8 11:59 PM)**

- Chapter 10: Development: Causes of the wealth and poverty of nations

Week 13, 11/09 - 11/13: **Guest Lecture** – Topic to Be Determined

- **Quiz 10** due Nov 15 at 11:59 PM

Week 14, 11/16 - 11/20: Human Rights

- Chapter 12: Human rights
- **Quiz 11** due Nov 22 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 6*

Week 15, 11/23 - 11/27: Thanksgiving Break

Week 16, 11/30 - 12/04: International Law and Norms & Review for Final Exam

- Chapter 11: International law and norms
- **Quiz 12** due Dec 6 at 11:59 PM
- *Discussion Session 7*

Week 17, 12/07 - 12/11: Final Exam (**Dec 7**)